AU LIBRARY MAPATHON

Drop in. Map something.

1. Sign in at the table.
2. Scan the survey code.
3. Grab a cheat sheet.



What's a mapathon?

- A group of people **mapping together** for a few hours, for a project that needs map data.
- Each person takes **one small square** of the map and traces what's in the satellite imagery.
- It all goes into **OpenStreetMap**, a free map anyone can use. Experienced mappers check every square.
- **No experience needed.** The next few minutes cover everything you need to start.

WHAT IS OPENSTREETMAP?

The free, editable map of the whole world, built by volunteers

Anyone can edit

Roads, buildings, trails and shops, added from imagery, GPS and local knowledge.

Open data

Free to use under the Open Database License, as long as you credit OpenStreetMap contributors.

Used everywhere

Apps, research, city planning and disaster response all build on it.

WHO IS HOT?

The Humanitarian OpenStreetMap Team connects mappers with responders

Started in 2010

Formed after the Haiti earthquake, when volunteers mapped the affected area remotely in days.

A bridge

Links the OpenStreetMap community with groups like the Red Cross, Médecins Sans Frontières (Doctors Without Borders) and the UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs.

Open tools

Runs the Tasking Manager we're using today, which splits big areas into small squares.

WHY HUMANITARIAN MAPPING MATTERS

Responders can’t reach people who aren’t on the map

Many of the places most vulnerable to disaster and poverty have little or no map data. Humanitarian mapping, also called crisis mapping, closes that gap: volunteers trace satellite imagery before a crisis hits.

Before you start

1. Make a free account at **openstreetmap.org:** `Sign Up`. Then click the link in your confirmation email.
2. Log in at **tasks.hotosm.org** with that account: `Log in`.
3. Haven't tried iD yet? Do the 10-minute walkthrough: on openstreetmap.org, `Edit`, then `Help › Start the walkthrough`. Nothing in it is saved.

What we trace today is step one. People who live there finish the map.

From above, we see shapes

Building outlines and roads. We can't see what a building is, who uses it, or what a place is called.

Local mappers add meaning

Street names, landmarks, health facilities and community places, in their own words.

So we map with care

Follow the project's instructions, map only what you can see, and leave names and labels to locals.

HOW A MAPATHON WORKS

Contributing to the map

1

Pick a square

In the HOT Tasking Manager, choose an open task on the project grid.

2

Trace in iD

Trace what the instructions ask for, from satellite imagery. Nothing to install.

3

Save and submit

Experienced validators review every task, so beginners can't break anything.

Step 1: Pick a square

1 PICK A SQUARE | 2 TRACE IN ID | 3 SAVE AND SUBMIT

1. At **tasks.hotosm.org**, search for project **#69108** and open it. Check that the number at the top matches.
2. Read the project's instructions: **what to map**, and which imagery to use.
3. Pick an available square on the map, then **Map › iD Editor**.

Step 2: Trace in iD

1 PICK A SQUARE | **2 TRACE IN ID** | 3 SAVE AND SUBMIT

Trace only what the instructions name, inside your square. Most projects ask for buildings; some for roads, or both.

- **Buildings:** press **3**, click each corner, close the shape, choose Building, press **Q** to square it.
- **Roads:** press **2**, click along the middle, press **Enter**, choose the road type the instructions name.

Step 3: Save and submit

1 PICK A SQUARE | 2 TRACE IN ID | 3 SAVE AND SUBMIT

1. Every 10 to 20 features: **Save**. Keep the project hashtag in the comment, add **#AUmapathon** and what you mapped, then **Upload**.
2. Back in the Tasking Manager: done with the square? Answer yes to “completely mapped” and submit. Out of time? **Stop mapping**.

Experienced validators review every task, so beginners can’t break anything.

THIS MONTH'S PROJECT

Mapping missing Buildings and Road in Bugesera District – Rilima Sector

PROJECT	WHERE	REQUESTED BY
#69108	Rwanda	EcoMappers, OSM Rwanda

Mapping Rwanda's critical infrastructure, vulnerable areas, and resources. Through this initiative, we aim to create accurate, accessible maps that empower local communities, support disaster preparedness and response, and drive sustainable development.

AU YOUTHMAPPERS IS BACK

“We don’t build maps. We build mappers.”

We’re relaunching our chapter of the global YouthMappers network, and we need student officers. Check the box on the sign-up sheet to talk about it.

Thank you for mapping

- See what we mapped today: ohsomeNow stats for **#AUmapathon**.
- Keep mapping any time at **tasks.hotosm.org**, with the same account.
- Check your OSM messages in the next week or two. Validators sometimes leave feedback on first edits.
- Next session: December 9, 11am-2pm.

Sources and credits

- OpenStreetMap: data © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL; docs CC BY-SA 2.0 (openstreetmap.org/copyright)
- Humanitarian OpenStreetMap Team: mission and history (wiki.openstreetmap.org/wiki/HOT; hotosm.org)
- Missing Maps: objectives, field mapping and organizer guides (missingmaps.org)
- Steps adapted from the LearnOSM guides, CC0 (learnosm.org), and the HOT Tasking Manager quick start
- YouthMappers mission and motto (resilience.asu.edu/youthmappers)